elmenue — Business & Development Master Plan

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1. Executive summary

elmenue is a browser-based café and restaurant system (guest QR ordering, waiter and kitchen screens, POS, inventory, loyalty, analytics) that competes on Arabic-first design, no hardware wall and a price far below Foodics-class cloud POS. The product is already built; the job now is to sell it safely, price it clearly and never interrupt a venue's service while doing so.

What you are selling: one system that replaces a paper menu, a waiter-call habit, a separate POS and a stock notebook. Entry point is a 350 EGP/month QR menu; the full system is 850-1,450 EGP/month, or a one-time licence of 20,000-80,000 EGP.

Three decisions this plan makes for you

1. **Pricing:** your two documents disagree (monthly tiers of 350-1,450 EGP in the master prompt, one-time 20k/40k/80k in the market PDF). Section 4 recommends offering **both**: monthly subscription as the default (recurring revenue, matches the multi-tenant design) and a one-time licence plus optional 12% yearly support for owners who refuse subscriptions.
2. **Safety:** every venue goes live through a **shadow-first** path. The old way of working (paper, existing POS, WhatsApp) keeps running until the venue has seen elmenue succeed for two weeks. Section 6 details it.
3. **Compliance gate:** ETA e-receipts are the biggest gap. Ask every prospect on day one whether they must issue them; sell to those who do not, and build or partner for ETA as the first paid feature.

Targets (from your Egypt plan, kept lean)

Horizon	Venues	Notes
Days 1-90	2-3 pilots at 30-40% off	testimonials, photos, bug list
Month 6	10 paying venues	break-even is about 3 venues on one-time pricing
Month 12	25 venues	second hire (support/onboarding)

2. Market, customers and competitors

Venues in Egypt already pay monthly for QR menus (100-200 EGP), cloud POS (1,000-5,000 EGP) and online ordering (28,000-45,000 EGP/year), so you are selling into a paid habit, not creating one. Prices below come from vendor pages in your market PDF and are indicative.

Who buys

Segment	Size	Pain	Best tier
Kiosk, takeaway, small café	up to ~10 tables	printed menus, no budget for POS hardware	Basic or Starter
Café / casual restaurant	~10-30 tables	waiters overloaded, lost orders, no sales data	Operations (core target)
Lounge, large restaurant, small chain	30+ tables, zones, staff	control, loyalty, branch reporting	VIP / Premium
Hotels, clubs, food courts	multi-outlet	brand look, reporting	VIP, custom

Competitors and your angle

Competitor type	Price seen	Your edge
QR-menu only (OrOMenu, Orders Egypt)	100-200 EGP/month	you add ordering, kitchen, bill split, POS
Cloud POS (Foodics, Geidea, Odoo, local)	1,000-5,000 EGP/month + 7,500-22,000 hardware	browser-only, uses tablets they own, Arabic-first
Online ordering (Ordable-type)	28,000-45,000 EGP/year	you do dine-in, they do delivery
Per-order QR (Queno)	flat fee per order, no subscription	fixed price, no fee growth with sales
Dgtera, Zlenu, VeraKit360, Besalla (named in your master prompt)	not verified	Egyptian Ammiya + Franco UI, loyalty, AI scan; verify their prices before quoting

Positioning line: "Your menu, your waiter, your kitchen screen and your reports on the phones you already own, in the Arabic your guests speak."

Honest weak spots to plan for: no ETA e-receipts yet, no online card payments yet, no offline mode, and a brand that is new against Foodics. Section 7 turns these into roadmap items.

3. Product: tiers, features, pages, statistics and reports

Three tiers are enforced in code (`features.js` : `basic` , `operations` , `vip`); higher tiers include lower ones. Everything below exists in the repo today unless marked **Planned**.

Tier feature map

Capability	Basic	Operations	VIP
Digital menu, table QR codes (secret table key)	yes	yes	yes
Micro-service buttons: water, napkins, cutlery, call waiter (sound + table number)	yes	yes	yes
Menu admin: categories, items, photos, sold-out, dietary tags, timed categories	yes	yes	yes
Guest ordering from phone, shared table cart, split bill, tip	-	yes	yes
Waiter/captain app: floor map, tickets, accept/reject, push alerts	-	yes	yes
Kitchen display (KDS) by station, timers, ready alert	-	yes	yes
Pending-edit window then kitchen lock (server-enforced)	-	yes	yes
Party size, table host, reservations, move/merge tables	-	yes	yes
Staff POS: takeaway/delivery tickets, discounts with cap, void with reason, cash/card/mixed, 80 mm receipt	-	yes	yes
Inventory: stock counts, low-stock, waste, movement log	-	yes	yes
English + Egyptian Ammiya + Franco	default only	yes	yes
Loyalty card by phone, EGP-to-points ratios, redemption	-	-	yes

Capability	Basic	Operations	VIP
AI photo menu scan (OCR)	-	-	yes
Admin AI copilot	-	-	yes
Premium themes (Dark Neon, Minimalist Luxury, Vibrant Egyptian, 24 more)	-	-	yes
Multi-branch analytics by group	-	-	yes

Pages and who sees them

- **Guest:** Home (branding, promotions, Wi-Fi, language, party size, Show Menu), Menu (six layouts), My order / Review, Bill, Profile, Loyalty card.
- **Waiter:** floor map or zone list, table dialog, tickets, reservations, POS, pay dialog.
- **Kitchen/bar:** ticket board with timers, one-tap sold-out.
- **Owner admin:** Analytics, Menu builder, Inventory, Orders, Floor editor, Staff, Reports, Theme and settings, QR codes, Audit, Loyalty, AI scan, Copilot, Branches.
- **Platform owner (you):** `/super` for tenants, tiers, suspension, custom domains, MRR and cafes per tier.

Statistics (each block has its own CSV export and a non-destructive Clear)

Summary (revenue, orders, average ticket, profit vs previous period), revenue by day and hour, sales by category, best sellers, rush hours, table usage, low stock, loyalty (members, points earned/redeemed/outstanding), branch revenue.

Reports (Excel/CSV): daily sales, orders with receipt reprint, discounts and voids, sales by staff and by order type, estimated profit, stock movement log, full backup, audit trail.

Planned, by value to the owner

1. ETA e-receipts (compliance gate)
2. Shift close, cash-up and Z-report
3. Offline order queue with sync
4. Online card payments (Paymob or similar)
5. WhatsApp order/receipt sharing
6. Guest feedback and rating dashboard
7. Recipe costing and supplier purchase orders
8. Cross-branch menu sync
9. SMS/OTP for loyalty (required before real customer data)
10. Printer automation (kitchen tickets)

4. Pricing, revenue model and financials

Decision: the pitch leads with the monthly plan; the one-time licence is offered only when an owner refuses a subscription. Both stay available so no owner is turned away. All figures are EGP, estimates from your Egypt plan, and quotes should expire in 7-14 days because the pound moves.

Option A: monthly subscription (recommended default)

Tier	Per month	Setup fee	Includes
Basic QR Menu	350-500	1,000-2,000	menu, QR, micro-services
Operations	850-1,000	3,000-5,000	ordering, waiter, KDS, POS, inventory
VIP	1,450+	5,000-8,000	loyalty, AI scan, copilot, themes, branches
Extra branch	50% of tier	50% of setup	same tier

Annual prepay: 2 months free. A Foodics-class POS at 1,500-3,000/month plus hardware is the anchor you compare against.

Option B: one-time licence (for owners who refuse subscriptions)

Package	One-time	Yearly support (12%)
Starter (~10 tables)	20,000	2,400
Standard (~30 tables)	40,000	4,800
Premium (multi-zone, reservations, roles)	80,000	9,600

Terms: 50% on signing, 50% at go-live. First 2-3 pilot venues 30-40% off for a testimonial. Hardware at cost plus 10-15%. Add-ons: printer/drawer setup 1,500-3,000; card payments 3,000-8,000 once built; custom work 500-1,000/hour; QR table stands 100-250 each at a margin.

Why both: hosting is a recurring cost to you, so a one-time deal must either include one year of hosting and charge after, or run on the venue's own mini PC (Model A in your plan).

Unit economics (your numbers)

- Cash cost per new venue: about 1,500 EGP, plus 12-20 hours of your time (setup 6-10, training 2-3, first-month support 3-6).
- Fixed yearly cost: about 83,000 EGP (hosting 12,000, domain/monitoring 4,000, backups 3,000, legal 10,000, accountant 24,000, marketing 20,000, contingency 10,000).

- Break-even: about 3 venues at a 35,000 average licence.
- Subscription view: 10 Operations venues at 900/month is 9,000/month, 108,000/year, before setup fees. At 25 venues with a VIP mix, expect 25,000-35,000/month recurring.

Pricing rules

- Never go below 15,000 one-time or 350/month: support cost and brand signal.
- Discounts only for pilots, annual prepay or multi-branch.
- Confirm VAT (14% or 15% sources conflict), sole proprietorship versus LLC, and your own e-invoicing duty with an accountant before the first invoice.

5. Sales playbook and benefits you can sell

Sell outcomes the owner can count, then show them live on `/demo` with the tier switcher.

Benefits by owner worry

Owner worry	What elmenue does	Proof to show
Waiters are overloaded	guests order and call water/napkins from the phone; waiter only serves	micro-service alert with table number
Wrong or lost orders	order goes straight to kitchen screen with timer	KDS demo
Staff theft and leakage	voids need a reason, discounts capped, audit log, stock movement log	audit and voids report
"I do not know my real profit"	revenue, cost, profit vs last period, best sellers, rush hours	analytics page
Slow table turnover	split bill and pay from the phone, bill request button	bill tab
Customers do not return	loyalty card by phone number, points, redemption	VIP card demo
Menu changes cost printing	edit price once, live everywhere; sold-out in one tap	admin menu
Tourists and youth	Egyptian Ammiya, English, Franco	language switch
No budget for hardware	runs on phones and tablets they own	cost comparison table

Owner worry	What elmenue does	Proof to show
Menu data entry is painful	photo scan (OCR) and Excel import	AI scan demo

Sales funnel

1. Lead sources: walk-in visits to cafes near you, Instagram/Facebook demo clips in Arabic, WhatsApp Business, referrals from pilot owners (give one free month per referral).
2. First meeting (15 minutes): ask about tax e-receipts, current POS, number of tables, peak hours, biggest daily headache. Show `/demo` on their own phone.
3. Free QR trial: put one QR on one table for a week (Basic tier, no ordering). Zero risk, see below.
4. Proposal in 24 hours: recommended tier, both pricing options, go-live date, rollback promise.
5. Contract: licence or subscription terms, 1 month free support, response times, data ownership, cancellation with data export.
6. Onboarding (section 6) and a 30-day check-in.

Objections

- "What if the internet drops?" Keep the paper/old POS path for the first weeks; offline queue is on the roadmap. Say it honestly.
- "Will it stop my work?" No: shadow mode first, nothing replaced until they choose.
- "Foodics is bigger." Yes, and costs 1,500-3,000/month plus hardware; you charge less and answer on WhatsApp.
- "Is our data safe?" Daily off-site backups, tenant isolation, exportable data.

Retention levers: monthly one-page report on WhatsApp to the owner, quarterly menu refresh visit, loyalty campaign templates, upgrade prompts when a Basic venue hits ordering questions.

6. Zero-downtime rollout and development plan

The rule: **a venue never depends on elmenue until elmenue has proven itself beside the old process.** This follows your SDLC report: Agile (Scrum) with incremental modules and DevOps practices, delivered by pilot, then phased rollout, with a short parallel run for payments. Direct switch-over is allowed only for tiny updates with a rollback ready.

A. Per-venue go-live path (the old process always keeps running)

1. **Week 0, prepare offline.** Import the menu (Excel or photo scan), photos, tables, zones, staff PINs on a private copy. Owner checks every price. Nothing is visible to guests yet.
2. **Week 1, QR-only trial (Basic).** One QR on 1-2 tables, ordering disabled. Guests only read the menu and press micro-service buttons. If anything fails, remove the stand; service is unchanged.
3. **Week 2, shadow mode (Operations).** Guests order on the phone, but staff **also** run the old way (paper chit or old POS). Compare totals at close each day; any difference is a bug ticket.
4. **Week 3, off-peak live.** Switch the quiet hours (morning, weekday afternoon) to elmenue first. Old process stays on the counter as backup.
5. **Week 4, payments parallel.** Cash and card are recorded in both systems for 5-7 days until the daily totals match to the pound.
6. **Week 5+, peak hours.** Go live for the rush only after a quiet week with zero blocking bugs and an experienced person on every shift. Keep paper chits in a drawer for 30 days.
7. **Day 30, retire the old process** only if the owner signs the handover record (what was installed, logins, backup plan).

B. Go / no-go gates (all must be true)

Gate	Pass condition
Data	owner verified menu, prices, tax and service %
Devices	tested on the venue's real phones, tablet and printer for one full shift
Staff	every waiter and kitchen user completed a 20-minute drill
Money	parallel totals matched for 5 consecutive days
Rescue	printed one-page "if the app is down" card at the counter and your WhatsApp number on it
Backup	last backup restored successfully on a test copy

C. Technical safety net (what you build and run)

- **Environments:** `main` (production), `staging` (own Supabase project, demo data), preview per branch. Never test on a live tenant.
- **Leave Vercel free before the first paid venue;** it is non-commercial. Use a small VPS multi-tenant server (about 500-1,000 EGP/month) or Vercel Pro + Supabase Pro (about 2,250 EGP/month).

- **Release rules:** deploy outside service hours (after 1 a.m. local or Tuesday morning); one change per release; tag each release in git; rollback = redeploy the previous tag (target under 5 minutes).
- **Feature flags per tenant:** new modules ship disabled and are switched on for the pilot venue first (reuse the existing `features.js` gating and a `flags` field in tenant settings).
- **Data safety:** every schema change must tolerate old data (`ensure()` in `tenant.js`); compare-and-swap saves already protect against lost updates; nightly off-site backup, weekly restore test; never delete sales (statistics Clear only moves a timestamp, keep that).
- **Automated tests before every deploy:** engine tests for billing (discount, service, tax, split), order lock, loyalty maths, tier gating, tenant isolation; plus a puppeteer smoke run of guest order to kitchen to pay.
- **Monitoring:** uptime ping on `/health` and on the guest page, error alerts to your phone, status message in the app when the connection drops.
- **Support:** one WhatsApp Business number, response targets (rush hours 15 minutes, otherwise 4 hours), a shared bug list.

D. Development process (Agile + DevOps, solo-friendly)

- Two-week sprints with the pilot owner as product owner; Friday demo on their phone.
- Backlog order: (1) hardening and security, (2) ETA e-receipts or reseller partnership, (3) shift close/Z-report, (4) offline queue, (5) card payments, (6) loyalty OTP, (7) WhatsApp sharing and feedback, (8) cost/recipes and purchasing, (9) cross-branch menu sync.
- Definition of done: tested on iPhone, Android and tablet; Arabic RTL with Western digits via `App.money()`; works on old data; rollback tested.
- Keep `tenant.js` environment-neutral because demo mode runs it in the browser.

E. First-sprint hardening (from your own security to-do)

- Rotate the Supabase secret key and every token shared in chats; change the live owner password and captain PIN; secrets only in environment variables.
- Rate-limit logins, enforce strong default passwords, confirm every route checks the tenant slug.
- Add SMS/OTP before storing real customer phone numbers for loyalty.
- Write a privacy note and data-processing clause for the contract (Egyptian personal data law) and have a lawyer review.

7. Risks, KPIs and 12-month roadmap

Roadmap

When	Business	Product / engineering	Gate to continue
Days 1-14	register business, tax card, bank account, domain	rotate keys, leave Vercel free, backups, staging environment	backups restore cleanly
Days 15-30	contract, invoice, handover templates; 3-minute Arabic demo video	automated tests, rollback drill, device test for a full shift	rollback under 5 minutes
Days 31-60	2-3 pilot venues at 30-40% off	fix pilot bugs, shift close/Z-report	parallel totals match 5 days
Days 61-90	Arabic landing page, WhatsApp button, first full-price sales	decide ETA build or partner	3 paying venues (break-even)
Months 4-6	10 venues, referral offer	ETA e-receipts, offline queue, loyalty OTP	zero blocking bugs for 30 days
Months 7-9	VIP upsells, chains	card payments (Paymob or similar), WhatsApp sharing, feedback dashboard	card flow tested on staging
Months 10-12	25 venues, first support hire	cost/recipes, purchasing, cross-branch menu sync	support load under 6 hours/venue/month

KPIs

KPI	Target
Pilot to paid conversion	2 of 3
Time from signing to go-live	under 5 weeks
Uptime (guest and staff pages)	99.5% or better
Support tickets per venue per month	under 4 after month 2
Monthly churn (subscription)	under 3%

KPI	Target
Basic to Operations upgrades	25% within 6 months
Monthly recurring revenue	10,000 EGP by month 6, 30,000 by month 12

Top risks

Risk	Impact	Response
Venue must issue ETA e-receipts	cannot sell to them	ask at first meeting; build or partner early
Outage during rush	lost trust	shadow-first rollout, paper backup card, off-hours releases, rollback
Internet or Wi-Fi failure	orders stall	cheap router advice now, offline queue in roadmap
Data loss or breach	business-ending	daily off-site backups, tenant isolation tests, rotated secrets
Loyalty phone numbers exposed	privacy claim	OTP before real data; privacy clause
Support drains your time	no growth	1 month free support, written response times, training video
Copying or resale	lost revenue	host it yourself, licence terms, deliver service not source
Pound moves	hosting cost rises	quote expiry, EGP pricing review every 6 months
Solo developer dependency	stall if ill	documented runbook, `PROJECT_GUIDE.md` kept current

Open questions for you

- Pricing decided: monthly leads, one-time is the fallback.
- Do you register as sole proprietorship or LLC, and who is your accountant?
- Which city and venue type first (pilot candidates)?
- Hosting choice: your own VPS or Vercel Pro + Supabase Pro?
- Competitor prices for Dgtera, Zlenu, VeraKit360 and Besalla were not verified; want me to research them?

Figures marked as estimates come from your Egypt market PDF and are not independently verified; tax and legal points need an accountant and lawyer.

8. Pitch script and proposal template

Lead offer: monthly plan first, one-time Owner's Licence second, never a lower list price.

15-minute first-meeting script

1. **Open (1 min):** "I'm not here to replace your system. I'll show you something on your own phone, and you decide."
2. **Discover (4 min), ask and listen:** How many tables? What do you use today (paper, POS, WhatsApp)? When is your rush and what goes wrong in it? Do you already issue tax e-receipts to the ETA? What do you pay monthly for your current system?
3. **Show (5 min):** open `/demo` on their phone. Scan, Home screen, order, kitchen screen, the water/napkins button, then the owner's analytics. Switch tiers to show Basic, Operations, VIP.
4. **Anchor (2 min):** "A cloud POS costs 1,500-3,000 EGP a month plus 7,500-22,000 for hardware. Elmenue runs on phones and tablets you already own."
5. **Offer (2 min):** "Operations is 900 EGP a month, setup included. If you prefer to pay once, the Owner's Licence is 40,000 EGP with one year of hosting and updates. Most owners take monthly because there is nothing to lose."
6. **Close (1 min):** "Let's put one QR on one table this week, free. You keep your current way of working. If you like it, we continue."

Answers to price pushback

- "Competitor X is cheaper." -> "Ask them what hardware, setup, training and support cost. I include them and answer on WhatsApp."
- "Too expensive." -> Offer annual prepay (2 months free) or a smaller tier, never a lower list price.
- "I want to pay once." -> Owner's Licence, with the terms below.

Proposal template (one page, sent within 24 hours)

Item	Content
Venue / owner / date	name, branch, tables, quote valid 7-14 days
Recommended tier	Basic / Operations / VIP and why, in two lines
Option A, monthly	price per month, setup fee, annual prepay price

Item	Content
Option B, Owner's Licence	one-time price (about 36-48 months of Option A), what is included
Included in both	menu setup, QR stands count, staff training sessions, 1 month free support
Go-live plan	free QR trial week, shadow week, quiet-hours live, payments in parallel, old process kept 30 days
Guarantee	cancel in the first 30 days and get your data exported; no lock-in
Payment terms	50% on signing, 50% at go-live; monthly plans billed in advance
Not included	hardware (cost plus 10-15%), custom features, new paid modules

Owner's Licence terms (put in the contract)

- Covers the current version of the chosen tier for the stated number of tables and branches.
- Includes 12 months of hosting, security fixes and updates; afterwards 12% of the licence per year, or hosting paid directly by the venue.
- New paid modules (for example ETA e-receipts, card payments) are quoted separately.
- Licence is for the named venue only, not transferable or resellable; data belongs to the venue and can be exported at any time.

Price ladder to keep you from underselling

Situation	Your move
Standard prospect	list price
Wants to pay yearly	2 months free
2+ branches	50% off the second branch
Competitor quote shown	add free setup or one free month
First 2-3 pilots	30-40% off for a testimonial and photos
Never	below 350 EGP/month or 15,000 EGP one-time

8. Venue migration playbook (every type of customer)

Migration means moving a venue from how it works today to elmenue without a single lost order. Pick the row that matches the venue; every path ends with the same rollback promise: the old process stays usable until the owner signs the handover.

Migration paths by starting point

Venue starts with	Risk	Path	Data to bring over	Rollback
Paper menu, paper chits, no POS	low	QR trial, shadow, off-peak, peak (section 6A)	menu, prices, table list, staff	keep paper chits
Another QR menu (monthly vendor)	low	run both QR stands side by side for 2 weeks, then remove theirs	menu via photo scan (VIP) or Excel; photos	their stand stays until you are stable
Existing POS (Foodics, Geidea, Odoo, local)	high	elmenue handles guest ordering and kitchen only; their POS stays the cashier and tax system	menu and prices; never touch their sales history	switch the guest QR off, cashier unchanged
Covered by ETA e-receipts	high	do not replace the cashier; sell Basic/Operations beside their POS until ETA is built	menu only	nothing to roll back
Multi-branch group	medium	pilot one branch, copy the setup to the rest with a shared group name	menu per branch (no cross-branch sync yet)	per-branch rollback
Hotel, club, food court	medium	one outlet at a time, outside event days	menu, outlets, room/zone list	per-outlet rollback

Data migration checklist

1. Collect: current menu (photo, PDF or Excel), prices, categories, item photos, table count and zones, staff names, tax and service %, opening hours.
2. Import into a private copy of the tenant (Excel import or AI scan); never type into the live tenant.

3. Owner verifies every price on a printed sheet and signs it.
4. Set stock counts only for items the owner wants tracked; start with zero tracked items if unsure.
5. Generate table QR codes with the secret table key; print, label and test each one with two phone types.
6. Create owner login, captain PINs and kitchen PIN; hand over in writing; change defaults.
7. Import opening loyalty members only with their consent and after OTP exists.

Staff training plan (non-technical teams)

Role	Length	Content
Owner/manager	60 min	admin tabs, menu edit, sold-out, reports, backups
Captain/waiter	20 min drill	accept order, micro-service alerts, pay dialog, void with reason
Kitchen/bar	15 min	ticket board, timers, ready button, sold-out
Everyone	printed one-page Arabic card	what to do if the screen or internet fails

What can never be done during service

- Changing prices, taxes or table numbers during a rush (do it before opening or after closing).
- Deploying a new version while the venue is open.
- Resetting statistics (Clear only moves a start date, but warn the owner anyway).
- Switching a venue to a newer tier without telling the staff what changes.

Handover record (signed by owner and you)

What was installed and which tier; logins and who holds them; backup schedule and last restore test; support hours and WhatsApp number; known limits (no ETA, no offline mode); date the old process may be retired.